

# Scout App v8.33 User Guide

A practical page-by-page guide for the person using Scout: what each feature means, what it does, and how the full outreach machine works from source finding to replies.

**The big idea: Scout is not just a sender. It is a full outreach system: find businesses, find websites, find emails, avoid bad contacts, send at smarter times, detect replies, classify auto replies/bounces, and keep a notification list for responses.**

## 1. Daily workflow

- Use Source Scout or the extension to bring in businesses/websites/emails.
- Run Auto Scout to find missing emails from websites.
- Use Verify/cleanup to keep only safe, useful contacts.
- Create Initial templates and Follow-up templates separately.
- Start durable sends from Message or save schedules.
- Run Operations -> Full Autopilot daily or let Vercel cron run hourly.
- Check Notifications and Replies for real responses.

## 2. What the tracking numbers mean

| Metric             | Meaning                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sent Tracked       | Messages accepted/saved as sent in Scout. This is all sent rows, not just the latest 1,000 UI rows.                                  |
| Real Replies       | Inbound Gmail messages classified as human replies and matched to sent messages. If it says 72, Scout found 72 real matched replies. |
| Auto Replies       | Out-of-office or automatic responses. These are useful but not counted as real buyer replies.                                        |
| No Inbox / Blocked | Bounces, address-not-found, blocked-message, no-inbox, and delivery-failure signals. These should be suppressed.                     |

**Gmail does not normally provide perfect inbox-delivered confirmation. Scout first records that Gmail accepted the send. Later, inbox sync changes the status when a bounce, blocked notice, auto reply, or real reply appears.**

## 3. Page-by-page guide

### Dashboard

Shows the command snapshot: business totals, sent/reply stats, and the compact send-time intelligence strip. The timezone strip scores buyer-local time but shows recommended next send time in the user current timezone.

### Operations

The control room. Run Full Autopilot to sync bounces, sync replies, repair Ready/Pending statuses, run due message schedules, run follow-ups, and run Auto Scout. This is the safest daily button.

### Notifications

Persistent response center. Real replies, auto replies, bounces, no-inbox notices, Gmail limits, job completed/failed signals, and worker warnings stay here until marked read. This is not only a popup.

### Upload Lists

Import CSV/business lists. Scout normalizes names, domains, emails, phones, categories, locations, and duplicate keys so the same lead is not accidentally created many times.

### Businesses

Main lead database. Each business has status: pending, review, found, ready, contacted, responded, no\_inbox, bounced, invalid, duplicate, or archived. Open a business to see conversation and actions.

### Verify Emails

Moves emails into safer statuses and helps separate usable contacts from risky/invalid records. Use before large sending.

### Source Scout

Paste or auto-fetch source text/pages. It parses business names, websites, and direct emails. Direct email leads can become Ready; website-only leads become Pending and can be queued for Auto Scout.

### Auto Scout

Email research engine. It takes Pending/Review businesses with no email, searches the website and likely contact pages, and promotes strict/evidenced emails only. v8.33 uses server worker queues so jobs remain after page leave.

### Templates

Message library. Initial templates are for first outreach. Follow-up templates are only for follow-ups. Reply templates are only for responding to inbound replies. This separation prevents wrong-message mistakes.

### Message

Starts durable message jobs. Pick template mode, sender mode, run caps, count, filters, and dry-run/spam override. When you click send, Scout saves a server job before sending starts; leaving the page does not erase the job.

### Replies

Shows sent tracked, real replies, auto replies, and no-inbox/blocked counts. It uses exact database counts, not just a 1,000-row UI cap. Sync Gmail to pull replies into the app.

## Deliverability

Seed-inbox and sender health area. Use it to understand sender limits, spam risk, blocks, and inbox placement checks.

## No Inbox

List of emails that bounced, had no inbox, or were blocked. These should not keep receiving follow-ups. Scout suppresses them from follow-up segments.

## Data Safety

Cleanup and safety controls. Useful for quarantine operations, duplicate cleanup, and keeping the database trustworthy.

## Settings

Connect Gmail accounts, set sender limits, configure seed tests, see account status, and manage keys/configuration that powers sending.

## Extension

Browser-side assistant for Google/Bing dorking. Use it when Google blocks server fetching or when browsing search pages manually. It captures and imports results without copy/paste.

# 4. How durable jobs work

- Message sends are saved into `message_schedules` before sending starts.
- Workers read from the database, not from the browser page state.
- The Message page can be closed after the job is created.
- Operations and cron can continue due jobs.
- Auto Scout jobs live in `email_research_jobs` and remain visible as `queued/running/done/failed`.
- If a worker stops, stale running jobs can be reset and continued later with remaining contacts.

# 5. How to know someone responded

- Run Full Autopilot or Inbox Sync.
- Scout scans Gmail for inbound messages newer than the configured window.
- It matches by Gmail thread ID first, then by recipient/business email.
- A real reply updates `reply_history`, `sent_messages` delivery status, the business status, and `app_notifications`.
- Open Notifications to see the persistent alert list. Open Replies to inspect the full reply records.

# 6. Dorking and no-copy workflow

- Server-side Bing/directory fetching can run automatically.
- Google is less reliable server-side because it blocks automation more aggressively.
- The browser extension is the reliable Google path because it captures the page you are viewing.

- The intended workflow is: niche/location -> generated dorks -> Google/Bing capture -> import to Scout -> Auto Scout finds missing emails -> Message sends -> Replies/Notifications track results.

## 7. Practical operating rules

| Rule                                        | Why it matters                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Keep Gmail connected                        | Without Gmail tokens, Scout cannot send or sync replies.                     |
| Run Operations daily                        | This keeps replies, bounces, schedules, and Auto Scout moving.               |
| Use follow-up templates only for follow-ups | Prevents wrong first-message content from being sent as a reply/follow-up.   |
| Check No Inbox before follow-ups            | Stops wasting sends on invalid or blocked addresses.                         |
| Use notification list                       | It is the fastest way to see real responses without hunting through pages.   |
| Respect buyer local time                    | Scout scores the buyer local time and shows next send time in your timezone. |

## 8. What makes the app creative

- It combines source discovery, email finding, sending, reply intelligence, deliverability, and notifications in one workflow.
- It separates first outreach, follow-ups, and reply templates so automation does not use the wrong message type.
- It treats bounces and auto replies as different signals instead of mixing everything into replies.
- It lets browser extension capture Google/Bing pages while server workers keep the backend moving.
- It adds timezone-aware timing without making the dashboard crowded.
- It turns every started send into a database job so browser navigation does not kill the work.